FREE CHRISTMAS BUDGET PLANNER

Christmas budget



Set a total you can pay for by December without new debt, split it into categories, then write down what you actually spend as you go.

TOTAL BUDGET	ALREADY SAVED	STILL TO SAVE	SAVE EACH WEEK
$	$	$	$
what you can afford	set aside so far	total minus saved	still to save ÷ weeks left

CATEGORY	BUDGET	SPENT	DIFFERENCE
Gifts for family	$	$	$
Gifts for friends	$	$	$
Teachers, hosts & coworkers	$	$	$
Stocking stuffers	$	$	$
Holiday meals & food	$	$	$
Baking, treats & drinks	$	$	$
Decorations & tree	$	$	$
Cards & postage	$	$	$
Wrapping paper, tags & bows	$	$	$
Travel	$	$	$
Outfits, events & outings	$	$	$
Giving & charity	$	$	$
Other	$	$	$
	$	$	$
TOTAL	**$**	**$**	**$**

SAVINGS TRACKER · WRITE THE AMOUNT YOU PUT ASIDE EACH WEEK

WEEK 1	WEEK 2	WEEK 3	WEEK 4	WEEK 5	WEEK 6	WEEK 7	WEEK 8
$	$	$	$	$	$	$	$

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Spending log



Write down every holiday purchase the day you make it, and keep a running total. Compare it with your budget each weekend.

DATE	WHAT I BOUGHT	CATEGORY	AMOUNT	RUNNING TOTAL

AFTER CHRISTMAS: WHAT I'D CHANGE NEXT YEAR

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How to set your budget



Five steps that keep Christmas fun in December and stress-free in January.

1. Start from what you can pay for, not what you'd like to spend: money already saved plus what you can set aside each week until mid-December.
2. Write down everyone you buy for before you shop, including teachers, hosts, coworkers and gift exchanges.
3. Split the total into the categories on page 1. Gifts are usually the biggest line, but food, travel and postage add up fast.
4. Leave a small Other line (about 5–10%) for the things nobody remembers until the last week.
5. Log every purchase on page 2 the same day. When a category is used up, move money from another one or stop spending in it.

COSTS PEOPLE FORGET

- [ ] Wrapping paper, tape and tags
- [ ] Postage for cards and parcels
- [ ] Batteries for new toys
- [ ] Teacher, coach and coworker gifts
- [ ] Secret Santa and gift exchanges
- [ ] Hosting extras: drinks, ice, disposables
- [ ] Travel: fuel, parking, pet sitting
- [ ] Holiday outfits and photos

WAYS TO SPEND LESS WITHOUT MISSING OUT

- Draw names for a Secret Santa among adults
- Set one per-person limit and stick to it
- For kids: something to want, need, wear and read
- Give homemade treats or a framed photo
- Shop from your list, not the store displays
- Buy next year's wrapping in the January sales

PLAN THE WHOLE SEASON

The printable Christmas Planner has 19 undated pages: a 6-week countdown, holiday budget, gift and card lists, Secret Santa, events, menu, baking and grocery planners, and checklists. Use it every year. gridleafstudio.com/christmas-planner/